

What is Plan Builder?

Plan Builder is an enterprise planning capability that allows leaders to plan their workforce against standard Amazon financial cycles. Plan builder integrates source of truth inputs from financial systems for cost per head and forecasted talent movement assumptions across attrition, transfers-out, and promotions. Through Plan Builder, leaders create numerous options and scenarios as they model their workforce for the upcoming year while understanding their financial responsibilities for the year.

Overview

Plan Builder allows leaders to create and refine their annual Operational Planning 2 (OP2) plans by testing various alternatives through a guided workflow interface in Amazon A to Z. Business Leaders can select any specific combination of assumptions or workforce attributes, visualizing real-time impacts on annualized and in-year Operational Expenditures (OpEx) run rates, workforce composition, and likelihood to achieve.

Features

Narrative Summary

Provides a leader with a summary of their inputs that set the stage for their planning cycle.

Areas of Focus

Provides initial insight into areas of friction or watch areas within a plan ahead of leaders taking action in further modules.

Impact summary

A real-time tracker on the sidebar that displays the impact of actions taken and tracks progress toward the leader's OpEx target, ensuring that the annual OP2 draft plan does not exceed the Finance-approved OpEx target.

This feature scrolls with the leader, so they can always see both how their actions in a module affect that particular module as well as their overall plan and progress to meeting their OpEx.

Instead of a linear scrolling experience, this is a modular experience, where each module is represented with a hyperlink that allows the user to go directly to the module.

Modules

Modules are presented separately so leaders can understand the core of each component, why it matters, what actions to consider taking. The order of the modules listed in this section is not significant. Based on the Summary, leaders can go out of order to address the highest areas of concern.

Start of year (SoY) Builders in seats (BIS) and Year-over-year (YoY) Reductions

SoY BIS is the first module that allows a leader to see what the headcount at the start of the year costs if annualized. This means keeping the same headcount each month with no losses or adds, but applying the unique monthly cost per head. This allows a leader to see how starting the year compares to the overall OpEx target. It also provides an advanced signal if natural talent movement alone will cover gaps when the OpEx is lower than the annualized costs.

Attrition

Measures how many existing employees are exiting your organization. Leaders can see their historical attrition rates and make adjustment against yearly or monthly rates.

Transfers-out

A historical rate of transfers out of an organization. When applied to a plan for the next year, the overall OpEx run rate for the year is reduced.

Promotions

A historical rate of promotion. When applied to the OpEx cost of maintaining the start of the year, builders that report to the business leader over the next full year get the OpEx rate for the year.

Talent movement encompasses attrition, transfers, and promotions. While Plan Builder automatically incorporate attrition and transfer rates, promotions are discretionary decisions. Therefore, leaders are initially presented with a baseline view excluding promotions. This choice allows leaders to build promotion plans that consider both short-term OpEx constraints and long-term organizational health requirements.

Backfill

Taking actions for backfill serve as the reallocation of available OpEx from attrition, transfers out, and the net impact of promotions in relation to the overall OpEx target.

YoY Growth

Provides leaders with a breakdown of YoY Growth initiatives and investments based on alignment with leadership and finance partners. The YoY Growth module is intended to specifically track incremental investments above the previous year's baseline operating expenses, focusing on new services or programs and expansions of existing ones.

Get started with Plan Builder

Before you begin

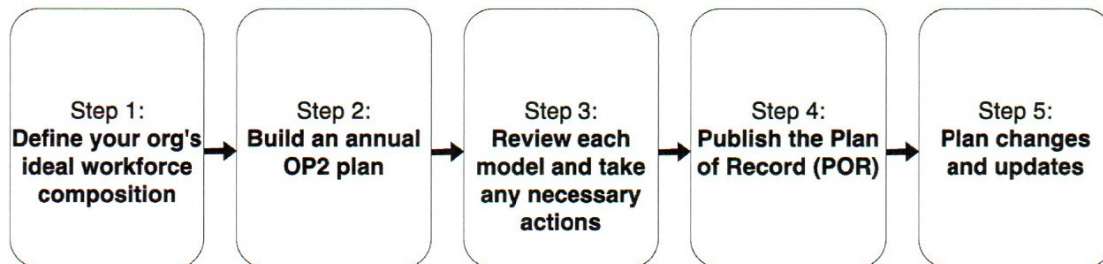
Before doing anything as a user, workforce planning (WFP) does behind-the-scenes work: it completes the automated process of data collection and generates baseline plan(s) (a start of the year plan).

Prerequisites

The following are the prerequisites for starting to work with Plan Builder:

- [Confirm as a Plan Owner, you can access WFP](#)
- [Review the permissions auto-assigned to plans - based on the onboarding process](#)

Workflow



Tasks

- [Step 1: Define your organization's ideal workforce composition](#)
- [Step 2: Build an annual OP2 plan](#)
- [Step 3: Review each module and take any necessary actions](#)
- [Step 4: Publish the Plan of Record \(POR\)](#)
- [Step 5: Plan changes and updates](#)

Confirm as a Plan Owner, you can access WFP

A Plan Owner is the authoritative owner of the plan and only they can [Publish the Plan for Record \(POR\)](#).

Permissions are based on user roles. For understanding the Plan Owner user role, and the three other roles (Finance Partner, Editor, and Viewer), and permissions for each of the roles, see the [Reference](#) > [Permissions](#) section.

Initial access for a Plan Owner is hardcoded and permissions are pre-loaded. Follow these steps to confirm as a Plan Owner, you can access WFP:

Steps

1. In Amazon A to Z, navigate to Workforce Planning home.
The page with this heading opens:
Workforce planning
Your workforce plans
There is a list of <Year> OP2 workforce plans.

The list of <Year> OP2 workforce plans that displays confirms you are a Plan Owner.

If an error page displays:

There may be an issue with your Plan Owner role and/or permissions. You can **create an issue** by navigating to the [SIM ticket](#) page. Provide all the necessary information:

- Requestor information (login, job level, organization)
- Specific plan(s) requiring access
- Access level requested: Plan Owner
- Detailed business justification
- Current role and relationship to the team

Review the permissions auto-assigned to plans – based on the onboarding process

As covered in the **Confirm as a Plan Owner, you can access WPF** prerequisite, permissions are based on user roles (Plan Owner, Finance Owner, Finance Partner, and Editor). There is a Your leadership team page that lists team members and their roles. To navigate to the page, perform the following steps:

Steps

1. In Amazon A to Z, navigate to Workforce Planning home.
The page with this heading opens:
Workforce planning
Your workforce plans
There is a list of <Year> OP2 workforce plans.
2. To select a plan: click **View population** next to the specific <Year> OP2 <Owner name> workforce plan you want to view.
The Plan page opens:
Workforce planning <Owner name> workforce plans
<Owner name> <Year> OP2
3. In the right pane, click **View your leadership team**.
The page with this heading opens:
Your workforce plans > Organizational preferences
Your leadership team
4. Review the table. As a Plan Owner, for your workforce plans, there is a list of employees and their roles.
[screenshot]

Step 1: Define your organization's ideal workforce composition

Important: This is a **required task**. You must complete the steps in this section (there are two parts: [Define your Job family strategy](#) and [Define your Job level strategy](#)), **before** proceeding to [Build an annual OP2 plan](#).

Using WFP, you can define and adjust your organization's target workforce composition. The process involves setting distributions for both job families and job levels, with built-in validations to ensure completeness and accuracy.

Effective WFP enables a leader to make intentional shifts in their organization's talent profile. This includes adjusting skills, experience levels, and geographic distribution to meet future customer needs and deliver work. This process begins when leaders assess their future strategic direction and identify the workforce capabilities that will execute it.

Summary of actions

- Access the workforce composition settings
- Review and adjust job family distributions
- Set job level targets
- Create specific composition targets for key job families
- Save the strategy to proceed to Plan Builder

Expected Outcome

Established clear targets for the composition of your organization. The targets are used in Plan Builder to guide decision making and plan creation.

Define your Job family strategy

As a first step to defining an ideal workforce composition, think about the critical skills you need for the calendar year to meet your business needs. Job family composition is a starting point highlighting the top job families that make up ~80% of your overall Start of Year BIS.

Steps

1. Navigate to **Amazon A to Z > WFP home page**.
2. For the desired annual OP2 workforce plan, click **Edit strategy**
The Edit *<Plan owner>* strategy for *<Year>* OP2 (Fixed) page opens.

Note: This page allows you to define your ideal workforce composition for this particular planning population. The system defaults to the percentage of your start of the year BIS composition for each section and planning dimension.

3. In the Job family strategy area, for each **Family**, review the default start-of-the year **Population targets (%)**. Determine what changes you want to make for the strategy of your org.

Note: The first section allows you as a leader to plan your ideal job family composition. This section will default to the top job families that represent ~80% of your start of year BIS population. You can review the current composition and determine where you want to update your strategy based on your business needs.

4. There are three ways to make changes. You can do any combination of the three, or none (retain the defaults):
 - 1) For each individual job family, change the number in the **Population targets (%)** input box.
 - 2) Click the **Add family** button for the system to generate an additional row to enter a target composition for a new job family not currently present in your organization.

Note: When adding a new family, there is no default input because there is no SoY BIS composition.

Next, 1) From the dropdown, select a **Family**, and 2) type a number in the **Population targets (%)** input box.

- 3) To define a specific job level composition for a job family, at the end of a row, toggle (move to the right) **Override level strategy**.
The system generates a new job family line of inputs for L4 to L8+ and presents the Start of Year BIS composition for the job family only in that view.

You can change the number (%) in any input box in the row for L4 – L8; the total must add up to 100%.

The system changes the **All job families** line to **Remaining job families**, reflecting the composition of all families that do not have an override set. This allows you as a leader to create specific job family and level targets while defining an overall strategy for remaining families.

Define your Job level strategy

You can define an L4 - L8+ level mix. This allows you to specify the right balance of experience for roles across your organization. There are two ways to define your L4 to L8+ strategy: 1) through the aggregate level mix (see the **Steps** below), or through the overrides you set in the previous strategy.

Steps

1. In the Level strategy area, for the row **All job families**, review the defaults for the Start of Year BIS composition for each level.
2. Modify any level by typing a new number (%) in an input box. Or retain the defaults.
After completing all changes to inputs, the job level inputs for all levels add up to 100%.
3. Save all your changes for both Job level and Job strategy. Click **Save strategy**.

Next steps

You can start the [Tasks](#) for the Plan Builder process. The first one is below: [Build an annual OP2 plan](#)

Plan Summaries

The [Features](#) section includes the [Impact summary](#), which is one of two types of Plan summaries. For more information about both types (Impact and AI-generated narrative summary), see: [Reference](#) > [Understanding Plan summaries](#).

Step 2: Build an annual OP2 plan

Steps

1. As a Plan Owner, navigate to **Amazon A to Z > WFP home**.
The page with this heading opens:
2. For the desired annual OP2 workforce plan, click **Build plan**.
Your workforce plans > Current plan
<Owner name> <Year> OP2 Plan
Scenario 1 tab (default) opens.

Step 3: Review each module and take any necessary actions

Plan Builder is designed as a modular interface that breaks each workforce planning component into individual modules so that leaders can see the individual impact of specific decisions and view the overall output of the plan.